

ZIMBABWE SCHOOL EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL (style)
ACADEX PRACTICE EXAMINATION
O-LEVEL · ENGLISH LANGUAGE

ENGLISH LANGUAGE 1122/2
PAPER 2 November 2022

2 hours

PAPER 2 — READING — COMPREHENSION, SUMMARY, REGISTER — 2 HOURS

These are **original ACADEX questions** written to match ZIMSEC syllabus structure, mark allocations and command words. They are **not** leaked or copied official papers. This script is unique to November 2022 1122/2.

Additional materials: The passage is printed in this paper. Dictionaries may NOT be used.

INSTRUCTIONS: Answer all questions. Spend about 1 hour 30 minutes on Section A (comprehension and summary) and 30 minutes on Section B (register).

SECTION A (40 marks) — Comprehension and summary

PASSAGE

A bicycle is honest

Sekuru's hands were a map of old cuts. He turned the bicycle upside down in the yard, the cracked saddle pointing at a sky the colour of diluted milk. Nokutenda held the wheel as he had been told, proud and slightly afraid of doing it wrong. "A bicycle is honest," Sekuru said. "If a spoke is lazy, the whole wheel tells you." He did not look up. He spoke to the metal the way some people speak to cattle, with respect that is not sentiment.

They lived at the edge of a growth point where the tar ended and the dust began. Kombi horns argued all afternoon. Nokutenda's school was three kilometres away. When the bicycle had failed last week, he had arrived with red soil to the knees and a late mark in the register. He had not cried, but he had felt the late mark as a kind of stain.

Sekuru loosened a nut, then put the spanner down and made Nokutenda loosen the next. "If I do it all, you will only own a ride. If you do it, you will own a skill." The boy's fingers slipped. He expected anger. Sekuru only spat to the side, not at him, and said, "Again. The iron does not hate you." A radio in the next yard played a gospel chorus too fast. Somewhere a baby protested the heat.

When the chain sat true, Sekuru spun the pedal with one finger. The sound was clean. He stood the bicycle up and held the handlebars towards Nokutenda as if presenting a diploma. "You will still be late if you start late," he added, because wisdom in that house always came with a sting. Nokutenda wheeled the bicycle to the path, then came back and picked up the greasy rag. He wiped the frame until the old red paint showed. It was not beauty. It was thanks, translated into work.

2. (a) Where does the scene take place, and why does the bicycle matter to Nokutenda? [3]
- (b) What does Sekuru mean by "A bicycle is honest"? [3]
- (c) Why does Sekuru insist that the boy loosen the nut himself? [3]
- (d) How does the writer show that Sekuru is strict but not cruel? [4]
- (e) Explain the last sentence in your own words. [3]
- (f) What is the effect of mentioning the radio and the baby? [4] **[20]**
3. Summarise in not more than 160 words what Sekuru teaches Nokutenda and how the boy responds. [20] **[20]**

SECTION B (10 marks) — Register · Answer ALL

4. A visitor asks you for directions to the Head's office. The best reply is: **[2]**

- A) This way, please. I'll show you.
- B) Can't you read the signs?
- C) Why do you want the Head?
- D) Ask someone else, I'm busy.

5. A shop assistant short-changes you. The appropriate register is: **[2]**

- A) Whatever, keep it, poor people.
- B) You thieves!
- C) Excuse me, I think the change is not correct. Could we check, please?
- D) Give me my money before I call the police, now!

6. Your little brother spills tea on a visitor. You say to the visitor: **[2]**

- A) He's always clumsy.
- B) I'm so sorry. Let me fetch a cloth.
- C) It's only tea.
- D) You should have moved.

7. On WhatsApp, your aunt asks you to greet your mother. You reply: **[2]**

- A) I will pass on your greetings, Aunt. Thank you.
- B) Tell her yourself lol.
- C) Mom is annoying today.
- D) K

8. Your friend has just failed a test and looks upset. The most appropriate comment is: **[2]**

- A) I'm sorry. We can go through it together if you want.
- B) I told you you were lazy.
- C) That paper was easy, actually.
- D) Failure is your brand now.

END OF QUESTION PAPER

Worked solutions and mark-scheme notes are inside the ACADEX app (Extract & Study).